

**Andrei Zhirnov**  
Curriculum Vitae  
February 2026

University of Exeter  
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## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Exeter:

|            |                                                                                                              |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| since 2022 | Lecturer in Quantitative Political Science                                                                   |
| 2020-2022  | Postdoctoral Research Fellow (“Populism Roots: Economic and Cultural Explanations in Democracies of Europe”) |
| 2019-2020  | Associate Lecturer in Quantitative Methods in Social Science                                                 |

Binghamton University:

|      |                                        |
|------|----------------------------------------|
| 2018 | Adjunct Lecturer, School of Management |
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## EDUCATION

|      |                                                                                                               |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2019 | Ph.D., Political Science, Binghamton University                                                               |
| 2010 | M.A., Political Science, Binghamton University                                                                |
| 2010 | M.A. (Hons.), Political Science, Moscow State Institute of International Relations (MGIMO-University)         |
| 2008 | B.A. (Hons.), Area Studies (South Asia), Moscow State Institute of International Relations (MGIMO-University) |

## PUBLICATIONS

### Refereed Journal Articles

**Zhirnov, A.**, Thomeczek, J.P., Antonucci, L., Scotto di Vettimo, M., Buma, R., Cristea, V., Kersting, N., Krouwel, A., Lange, S., López Ortega, A., Thompson, J., Di Stefano, R., and Ruggeri, F. “A Populist Axis? Analyzing Connections Between Populist, Economic, and Cultural Dimensions of Political Space.” OnlineFirst in *Comparative Political Studies*. doi:10.1177/00104140261418623

Thomeczek, J.P., **Zhirnov, A.**, Scotto di Vettimo, M., Buma, R., Cristea, V., Dolle, M., Kersting, N., Krouwel, A., Lange, S., López Ortega, A., Thompson, J., Antonucci, L., Di Stefano, R., and Ruggeri, F. “One model to rule them all? Choosing two-dimensional spaces for European political landscapes with VAA data.” Forthcoming in *Journal of Information Technology and Politics*. doi:10.1080/19331681.2025.2469166

**Zhirnov, A.**, Thomeczek, J.P., Scotto di Vettimo, M., López Ortega, A., Krouwel, A., Antonucci, L., Di Stefano, R., Kersting, N. 2025. “How congruent are populist parties with their constituencies? Evidence from the 2019 European Parliament Elections in Italy, the Netherlands, Germany and Sweden.” *Electoral Studies* 94, 102906. doi:10.1016/j.electstud.2025.102906

**Zhirnov, A.**, and Adeel, A.B. 2025. “The informal economy and the reach of policy interventions: Evidence from the COVID-19 lockdown in India.” *Review of Development Economics* 29(1): 247-268. doi:10.1111/rode.13129

**Zhirnov, A.**, Antonucci, L., Thomeczek, J.P., Horvath, L., D’Ippoliti, C., Mongeau Ospina, C.A., Krouwel, A., and Kersting, N. 2024. “Precarity and populism: Explaining populist outlook and populist voting in Europe through subjective financial and work-related insecurity.” *European Sociological Review* 40(4): 704–720. doi:10.1093/esr/jcad052

**Zhirnov, A.**, Moral, M., and Sedashov, E. 2023. “Taking Distributions Seriously: On the Interpretation of the Estimates of Interactive Nonlinear Models.” *Political Analysis* 31(2): 213-234. doi:10.1017/pan.2022.9

Shvetsova, O., **Zhirnov, A.**, Giannelli, F., Catalano, M., and Catalano, O. 2022. “Governor’s Party, Policies, and COVID-19 Outcomes: Further Evidence of an Effect.” *American Journal of Preventive Medicine* 62(3): 433-437. doi:10.1016/j.amepre.2021.09.003

Shvetsova, O., Julie VanDusky-Allen, **Zhirnov, A.**, Adeel, A.B., Catalano, M., Catalano, O., Giannelli, F., Muftuoglu, E., Rosenberg, D., Halit Sezgin, M., and Zhao, T. 2021. “Federal Institutions and Strategic Policy Responses to COVID-19 Pandemic.” *Frontiers in Political Science: Elections and Representation* 3:631363. doi:10.3389/fpos.2021.631363

Adeel, A.B., Catalano, M., Catalano, O., Gibson, G., Means, J., Muftuoglu, E., Riggs, T., Halit Sezgin, M., Shvetsova, O., Tahir, N., VanDusky-Allen, J., Zhao, T., **Zhirnov, A.** 2020. “COVID-19 Policy Response and the Rise of the Sub-national Governments.” *Canadian Public Policy/ Analyse de politiques* 46(4): 565-584. doi:10.3138/cpp.2020-101

Shvetsova, O., **Zhirnov, A.**, VanDusky-Allen, J., Adeel, A.B., Catalano, M., Catalano, O., Giannelli, F., Muftuoglu, E., Riggs, T., Halit Sezgin, M., Tahir, N., and Zhao, T. 2020. “Institutional Origins of Protective COVID-19 Public Health Policy Responses: Informational and Authority Redundancies and Policy Stringency.” *Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy* 4(1): 585-613. doi:10.1561/113.000000023

**Zhirnov, A.**, and Mufti, M. 2019. “The Electoral Constraints on Inter-Party Mobility of Candidates: The Case of Pakistan.” *Comparative Politics* 51(4): 519-554. doi:10.5129/001041519X15647434970045

**Zhirnov, A.** 2019. “Decision Period and Duverger’s Psychological Effect: Evidence from India.” *Electoral Studies* 58: 21-30. doi:10.1016/j.electstud.2019.01.004

Moral, M., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2018. “Issue Voting as a Constrained Choice Problem.” *American Journal of Political Science* 62(2): 280-295. doi:10.1111/ajps.12342

**Zhirnov, A.** 2016. “Electoral Coordination in India: The Role of Costly Campaign Communication.” *India Review* 15(4): 359-378. doi:10.1080/14736489.2016.1235937

**Zhirnov, A.** 2016. “Campaigns, Information, and Coordinated Voting in Multi-Party Elections under Plurality Rule.” *Electoral Studies* 41: 190–201. doi:10.1016/j.electstud.2016.01.002

Best, R.E., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2015. “Perils and Pitfalls of Ignoring Disproportionality’s Behavioral Component.” *Electoral Studies* 40: 256-267. doi:10.1016/j.electstud.2015.09.010

## Book Chapters

Adeel, A.B., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2023. “COVID-19 Response in India, Pakistan, And Bangladesh: Shared History, Different Processes”. In *Government Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic: Between a Rock and a Hard Place* (ed. Olga Shvetsova). Cham: Palgrave Macmillan. 75-106. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-30844-4\_4

Shvetsova, O., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2023. “Commonalities and Differences in Governments’ COVID-19 Public Health Responses Around the World.” In *Government Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic: Between a Rock and a Hard Place* (ed. Shvetsova, O.). Cham: Palgrave Macmillan. 223-242. doi:10.1007/978-3-031-30844-4\_10

Mershon, C., Shvetsova, O., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2019. “Games and Uncertainty in U.S. Criminal Justice Systems.” In *Formal Modeling in Social Science*, by Mershon, C., and Shvetsova, O., 155-184. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.

**Zhirnov, A.** 2010. “Issues of Territorial Stability in India.” In “*Giant*”-States: Problems of Territorial Stability, eds. I.M. Busygina, L.V. Smirnagin, M.G. Filippov, 180-205. Moscow: MGIMO-University.

## Datasets

Shvetsova, O., **Zhirnov, A.**, Adeel, A.B., Bayar, M.C., Bayrali, O.G., Catalano, M., Catalano, O., Chu, H., Giannelli, F., Muftuoglu, E., Rosenberg, D., Seyis, D., Skopyk, B., VanDusky-Allen, J., and Zhao, T. 2022. “Protective Policy Index (PPI): global dataset of origins and stringency of COVID 19 mitigation policies.” *Scientific Data* 9: 319. doi:10.1038/s41597-022-01437-9. Dataset available at <https://github.com/COVID-policy-response-lab/PPI-data>.

## Other Publications

Shvetsova, O., **Zhirnov, A.**, Giannelli, F., Catalano, M., and Catalano, O. 2022. “Can Correlation Between Governor’s Party and COVID-19 Morbidity Be Explained by the Differences in COVID-19 Mitigation Policies in the States?” *American Journal of Preventive Medicine* 62(6): e381-e383. doi:10.1016/j.amepre.2022.01.003.

Thomeczek, J.P., Kersting, N., André Krouwel, Banducci, S., Antonucci, L., D’Ippoliti, C., **Zhirnov, A.**, Horvath, L., Mongeau Ospina, C.A. 2021. “Der Polit-Kompass: Eine neue VAA zum aufkeimenden Populismus.” *regierungsforschung.de*, Universität Duisburg-Essen. <https://regierungsforschung.de/der-polit-kompass-eine-neue-vaa-zum-aufkeimenden-populismus/>

VanDusky-Allen, J., Shvetsova, O., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2020. “COVID-19 Policy Response in Argentina, Brazil, and Mexico: Three Different National-Subnational Approaches.” *Duck of Minerva*, July 2, 2020. <https://duckofminerva.com/2020/07/covid-19-policy-response-in-argentina-brazil-and-mexico-three-different-national-subnational-approaches.html>

VanDusky-Allen, J., Shvetsova, O., and **Zhirnov, A.** 2020. “Brazilian Federalism and State Level Policy Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic.” *The Blue Review*, June 17, 2020. <https://www.boisestate.edu/bluereview/brazilian-federalism/>

Shvetsova, O., **Zhirnov, A.**, Adeel, A.B., Catalano, M., Catalano, O., Chu, H., Dumond, G.K., Ghincea, G.-M., Means, J., Muftuoglu, E., Riggs, T., Sadykova, A., Halit Sezgin, M., VanDusky-Allen, J., and Zhao, T. 2020. *Constitutional and Institutional Structural Determinants of Policy Responsiveness to Protect Citizens from Existential Threats: COVID-19 and Beyond*. Citizenship, Rights, and Cultural Belonging Working Paper No. 104. [https://orb.binghamton.edu/working\\_paper\\_series/4](https://orb.binghamton.edu/working_paper_series/4)

## HONOURS AND AWARDS

|            |                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2022       | Fellow of Advance HE                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2018       | Robert I. Hofferbert Award for the Best Graduate Student Paper, awarded for “Institutional Constraints on Coalition Formation” (with Evgeny Sedashov and Mert Moral) |
| 2016, 2015 | Polmeth Travel Award                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2015, 2013 | Graduate Student Employee Union Professional Development Awards                                                                                                      |
| 2014       | Dissertation Year Fellowship                                                                                                                                         |
| 2014       | Binghamton Foundation Travel Award                                                                                                                                   |
| 2014       | Ali A. Mazrui Award to an International Graduate Student in the Political Science Department                                                                         |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Convened undergraduate modules in quantitative research methods

- Data Analysis in Social Science III (2025)
- Data Analysis in Social Science II (2020, 2022, 2023)

Convened postgraduate modules

- Statistical Modelling (2025)
- Quantitative Data Analysis and Applied Quantitative Data Analysis (2022, 2024, 2025)
- Programming for Social Data Science (2023)
- Data Visualisation (2020)

Undergraduate dissertation coordinator

- Quantitative dissertations (since 2022)
- Politics dissertations (since 2024)

Supervise postgraduate dissertations (since 2022)

Supervise undergraduate dissertations (since 2020)

Co-supervise Ph.D. students (since 2022)

## SERVICE TO PROFESSION

Reviewed for the *American Political Science Review*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *Canadian Public Policy*, *Electoral Studies*, *European Journal of Political Research*, *India Review*, *Journal of Elections*, *Public Opinion and Parties*, *Oxford Economic Papers*, *Political Science Research and Methods*, *Journal of Politics*

Organised the 2021 Exeter Q-Step/NCRM Research Methods Series

Conference Co-organizer (with Benjamin Farrer), *Parties and Party Systems*, Annual Dr. Han-Jyun Hou Conference at Binghamton University, May 31, 2013.

## PROFESSIONAL MEETINGS AND WORKSHOPS

Conference of Society for Advancement of Socio-Economics: 2024

ECPR Joint Sessions of Workshops: 2023

ECPR General Conference: 2022

Polmeth Europe: 2021, 2022

Annual meetings of American Political Science Association: 2014, 2016, 2021

Advanced Research Colloquium: 2021

Binghamton University Data Salon: 2021

Annual meetings of Midwest Political Science Association: 2011, 2012, 2013, 2014, 2015, 2018, 2021, 2022

Annual meeting of the Society for Political Methodology: 2015, 2016, 2018

Behavioral Models of Politics Workshop: 2017

Annual Graduate Student Conference on Political Economy, Alexander Hamilton Center, New York University: 2013, 2015

Annual meetings of Public Choice Society: 2013, 2014, 2015

World Congress of International Political Science Association: 2014

“Institutions in Context: Inequality” workshop, University of Tampere: 2013

Political Science Annual Dr. Han-Jyun Hou Conference, Binghamton University: 2012

## ADDITIONAL TRAINING

|           |                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020-2022 | Postgraduate Certificate in Academic Practice, University of Exeter                                                                                 |
| 2012      | Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models (EITM) Summer Institute, Princeton University                                                          |
| 2011      | ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, Ann Arbor, MI                                                                                         |
| 2009      | Seminar “Theory and Methods of Political Science,” Prof. Stein U. Larsen (University of Bergen), Moscow State Institute for International Relations |

## SOFTWARE PROFICIENCY

R, Stata, SAS, Python, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, SQL, Git, Docker